Balsamic Vinaigrette

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🫗 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🍇 1/2 cup balsamic vinegar
- 🟡 2 tsp dijon mustard
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🧂 1 tsp salt
- 🟣 1/4 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Whisk together olive oil 🫗, balsamic vinegar 🍇, dijon mustard 🟡, garlic powder 🧄, honey 🍯, salt 🧂, and black pepper 🟣
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Caesar Dressing

Servings: 1 cup

Prep: Mayonnaise

- 🥚 1 egg yolk
- 🫗 200ml sunflower oil
- 🍋 1 tsp lemon juice
- 🧂 Pinch of salt

1. Whisk the egg yolk 🥚 with lemon juice 🍋 and salt 🧂
2. Slowly drizzle in the oil 🫗 while whisking until emulsified

Ingredients

- 🫐 1 cup mayonnaise (from prep above)
- 🧀 1/2 cup parmigiano reggiano, grated
- 🟤 2 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- 🐟 4 anchovies
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves

Steps

1. Combine mayonnaise 🫐, parmigiano 🧀, Worcestershire sauce 🟤, anchovies 🐟, and garlic 🧄 in a food processor. Blend until smooth
2. Transfer to a container and refrigerate

Notes

Produces a thicker version of the classic dressing

All ingredients should be at room temperature for best results

For Caesar salad: toss with romaine lettuce and croutons, top with more parmigiano 🧀

Chili Lime Dressing

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🍏 2 limes, zest and juice
- 🍇 1/4 cup red wine vinegar
- 🍶 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🫗 1/3 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🌶️ 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes
- 🌱 1 tsp ground cumin
- 🧂 1/2 tsp salt

Steps

1. Whisk together lime zest and juice 🍏, red wine vinegar 🍇, soy sauce 🍶, honey 🍯, olive oil 🫗, garlic powder 🧄, red pepper flakes 🌶️, cumin 🌱, and salt 🧂
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Lemon Vinaigrette

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🫗 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🍇 1/2 cup balsamic vinegar
- 🟡 2 tsp dijon mustard
- 🍋 1 lemon, zest and juice
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🧂 1 tsp salt
- 🟣 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 🌿 2 tsp dried oregano

Steps

1. Whisk together olive oil 🫗, balsamic vinegar 🍇, dijon mustard 🟡, lemon zest and juice 🍋, garlic powder 🧄, honey 🍯, salt 🧂, pepper 🟣, and oregano 🌿
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Mayonnaise

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

🥚 1 large egg yolk
🟡 1 tbsp dijon mustard
🍋 1 lemon, juiced
🫗 1 cup vegetable oil
🧂 Salt to taste
🟣 Black pepper to taste

Steps

1. Combine egg yolk 🥚, dijon mustard 🟡, and lemon juice 🍋 in a blender. Blend until mixed
2. With the blender on low, slowly drizzle in the oil 🫗 — go gradually to emulsify properly
3. Continue adding oil 🫗 until fully incorporated and thick
4. Season with salt 🧂 and pepper 🟣. Refrigerate

Notes

All ingredients should be at room temperature
If too thick, whisk in a teaspoon of water

Pesto

Servings: 4

Ingredients

🌿 2 cups fresh basil leaves, packed
🧀 1/2 cup grated parmesan
🌰 1/3 cup pine nuts
🧄 3 garlic cloves
🧂 1/4 tsp salt
🟣 1/8 tsp black pepper
🫗 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil

Steps

1. Place basil 🌿, parmesan 🧀, pine nuts 🌰, garlic 🧄, salt 🧂, and pepper 🟣 in a food processor
2. Slowly drizzle in olive oil 🫗 while the processor is running
3. Pulse until smooth

Notes

Swap pine nuts 🌰 for walnuts, almonds, or sunflower seeds
Swap basil 🌿 for spinach, arugula, radish leaves, or kale
Stores in the fridge up to a week, freezes up to 3 months

Sesame Ginger Dressing

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

🫗 1/3 cup extra virgin olive oil
🏺 2 tbsp toasted sesame oil
🍶 1/4 cup rice vinegar + 2 tbsp soy sauce
🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
🍯 1 tbsp honey
🫚 2 tsp ground ginger

Steps

1. Whisk together olive oil 🫗, sesame oil 🏺, rice vinegar and soy sauce 🍶, garlic powder 🧄, honey 🍯, and ginger 🫚
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks
Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Baba Ganoush

Servings: 4

Ingredients

🍆 2 medium eggplants
🥄 3 tbsp tahini
🍋 1 lemon, juiced
🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
🫐 1 tbsp Greek yoghurt
🧂 1/4 tsp salt
🟣 1/8 tsp pepper
🌿 1 tsp sumac
🫗 2 tbsp olive oil
🌶️ 1 tsp red pepper flakes (optional)

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 200°C. Poke the eggplants 🍆 with a fork, place on a baking sheet and roast 30–40 min until charred and soft
2. Let the eggplants 🍆 cool 15 min, then peel off and discard the skin
3. Place the eggplant 🍆 flesh in a food processor with tahini 🥄, lemon juice 🍋, garlic 🧄, yoghurt 🫐, salt 🧂, pepper 🟣, sumac 🌿, and red pepper flakes 🌶️. Pulse until smooth
4. Transfer to a serving dish, drizzle with olive oil 🫗. Serve with pita or fresh vegetables

Notes

Stores in an airtight container in the fridge for up to a week

Cauliflower Velouté

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🌸 1 large cauliflower, cut into florets
- 🥔 2 medium potatoes, peeled and diced
- 🫗 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🧅 1 onion, chopped
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌱 1 litre vegetable broth
- 🌿 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Heat olive oil 🫗 in a large pot. Sauté onion 🧅 and garlic 🧄 until soft, about 5 min
2. Add cauliflower 🌸, potatoes 🥔, and broth 🌱. Bring to a boil, then simmer 20 min until tender
3. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. Stir in thyme 🌿, season with salt and pepper 🧂

Notes

Keeps in the fridge 5 days, freezes up to 3 months
For richer flavour, roast the cauliflower 🌸 before adding to the pot
Serve with crusty bread or a side salad

Hummus

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥫 400g can chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- 🍋 2 lemons, juiced
- 🧄 1 garlic clove
- 🧂 1/2 tsp fine sea salt
- 🥄 1/2 cup tahini
- 💧 2 tbsp water
- 🌿 1/2 tsp ground cumin
- 🫗 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil

Steps

1. Place chickpeas 🥫, lemon juice 🍋, garlic 🧄, tahini 🥄, salt 🧂, water 💧, cumin 🌿, and olive oil 🫗 in a food processor. Pulse until smooth
2. If too thick, add water 💧 one tablespoon at a time. Adjust seasoning
3. Transfer to a serving dish and drizzle with olive oil 🫗

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to a week
Garnish with parsley, paprika, or toasted pine nuts

Pumpkin Miso Soup

Servings: 4

Prep: Roasted Pumpkin

🎃 1 medium pumpkin
🫗 2 tbsp olive oil

1. Preheat oven to 200°C. Cut the pumpkin 🎃 in half, scoop out seeds, leave skin on
2. Spread olive oil 🫗 on the pumpkin 🎃 halves, place on a baking sheet
3. Roast 25–30 min until tender and edges are slightly browned
4. Cool 10 min, then scoop out flesh and discard skin

Ingredients

🏺 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil
🧅 1 medium yellow onion, finely chopped
🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
🧡 1 tbsp fresh ginger, grated
🍸 1 litre vegetable broth
🎃 400g pumpkin purée (from prep above)
🥄 3 tbsp white miso paste
🥢 1 tbsp soy sauce
🧂 Salt and pepper to taste
🟢 Sliced green onions or nori strips (optional)

Steps

1. Heat sesame oil 🏺 in a large pot. Sauté onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, and ginger 🧡 until translucent, about 5 min
2. Stir in pumpkin purée 🎃 and broth 🍸. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a simmer
3. Add soy sauce 🥢 and miso paste 🥄 — do not boil after adding miso
4. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. Simmer 20 min
5. Season with salt and pepper 🧂. Serve garnished with green onions 🟢

Notes

Stores in the fridge up to a week, freezes well
Substitute butternut squash for pumpkin 🎃
Add a splash of coconut milk for creamier texture

Red Lentil Soup (Instant Pot)

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🔴 1 1/2 cups red lentils, rinsed
- 🧅 1 onion, diced
- 🥕 2 carrots, diced
- 🧄 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 🫗 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🌿 1 tsp cumin + 1 tsp turmeric + 1/2 tsp paprika
- 🍅 1 can (400g) diced tomatoes
- 🍸 4 cups vegetable broth
- 🍋 1 lemon, juiced
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Set Instant Pot to sauté. Heat olive oil 🫗, cook onion 🧅, carrots 🥕, and garlic 🧄 for 3 min
2. Add spices 🌿 and stir 30 seconds until fragrant
3. Add lentils 🔴, tomatoes 🍅, and broth 🍸. Stir to combine
4. Seal and pressure cook on high for 10 min. Natural release 10 min
5. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. Stir in lemon juice 🍋, season with salt and pepper 🧂

Notes

Top with a swirl of olive oil and fresh cilantro
Freezes well for up to 3 months

Shrimp & Corn Chowder

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥓 4 slices bacon, diced
- 🦐 450g medium shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 🧄 3 garlic cloves, diced
- 🧅 1 onion, diced
- 🌶️ 2 tsp smoked paprika + 1/2 tsp oregano + 1/2 tsp basil
- 🍗 4 cups chicken stock
- 🌽 2 cups corn kernels
- 🥛 1/4 cup heavy cream
- 🌿 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Cook bacon 🥓 in a large pot until crispy. Set aside, keep 1 tbsp fat
2. Sear shrimp 🦐 in the pot until pink, about 2 min. Set aside
3. Sauté garlic 🧄 and onion 🧅 until translucent. Add spices 🌶️, season with salt and pepper 🧂
4. Add chicken stock 🍗 and corn 🌽. Boil, then simmer 15 min until thickened
5. Stir in cream 🥛 and blend with an immersion blender
6. Serve topped with shrimp 🦐, bacon 🥓, and parsley 🌿

Notes

Roasted corn adds extra smoky sweetness

Tzatziki

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🫐 1 cup Greek yoghurt
- 🥒 1 cucumber, peeled and grated
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌿 1 tbsp fresh dill or mint, chopped
- 🫗 1 tbsp olive oil
- 🍋 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Grate the cucumber 🥒, place in a sieve and press out as much liquid as possible. Let drain a few minutes
2. Combine drained cucumber 🥒, yoghurt 🫐, garlic 🧄, olive oil 🫗, lemon juice 🍋, and dill 🌿 in a bowl. Mix well
3. Season with salt and pepper 🧂. Adjust garlic 🧄 and herbs 🌿 to taste
4. Refrigerate at least 1 hour before serving

Notes

Drain the cucumber 🥒 thoroughly to avoid watery tzatziki
Stores in the fridge for a few days

Lomo Saltado

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥩 500g beef sirloin, cut into strips
- 🧅 1 red onion, sliced into wedges
- 🍅 2 tomatoes, cut into wedges
- 🌶️ 1 ají amarillo (or jalapeño), sliced
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🥄 2 tbsp soy sauce
- 🍇 2 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 🫗 2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 🥔 2 large potatoes, cut into fries
- 🌿 Fresh cilantro, chopped

Steps

1. Fry the potatoes 🥔 until golden and crispy. Set aside
2. Heat oil 🫗 in a wok over high heat. Sear the beef 🥩 in batches until browned. Set aside
3. In the same wok, stir-fry onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, and ají amarillo 🌶️ for 1 min
4. Add tomatoes 🍅, soy sauce 🥄, and vinegar 🍇. Toss for 30 seconds
5. Return the beef 🥩, add fries 🥔, and toss together. Garnish with cilantro 🌿

Notes

Serve with steamed white rice
The wok must be very hot for proper searing

Mediterranean Baked White Fish

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🐟 4 white fish fillets (cod, halibut, or sea bass)
- 🫗 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🍋 1 lemon, juiced and zested
- 🧄 4 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌿 2 tsp dried oregano + 1 tbsp fresh thyme
- 🧅 1 red onion, minced
- 🍅 300g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 🫒 100g pitted olives (kalamata, green, or mix)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 200°C
2. Mix olive oil 🫗, lemon juice 🍋, garlic 🧄, herbs 🌿, salt and pepper 🧂
3. Place fish fillets 🐟 in a baking dish. Pour the herb-lemon mixture over them, coating evenly
4. Scatter cherry tomatoes 🍅, olives 🫒, and red onion 🧅 around and on top of the fish 🐟
5. Bake 15–20 min until the fish 🐟 flakes easily with a fork

Notes

Serve with rice, couscous, or a green salad
Add capers for extra Mediterranean flavour

Merguez Vegetable Tagine

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🥓 450g merguez sausage
- 🧅 2 sweet white onions, sliced
- 🥕 250g carrots, peeled and sliced lengthwise
- 🎃 1 small butternut squash, peeled and chopped
- 🥒 250g zucchini, sliced lengthwise
- 🧄 3 garlic cloves, chopped
- 🫒 1 cup green olives, pitted
- 🍋 1 lemon, quartered
- 🫘 1 cup cooked chickpeas
- 🍇 1/2 cup golden raisins + 1/2 cup dried apricots, chopped
- 🌿 1 cup cilantro, finely chopped
- 🟤 2 tsp cinnamon + 1 tsp coriander + 2 tsp paprika + 1 tsp turmeric + 3 tsp cumin
- 🫗 1/4 cup olive oil
- 🍗 3 cups chicken stock
- 🌾 1 tbsp flour

Steps

1. Heat olive oil 🫗 in a large pot. Add the spice mix 🟤 and stir briefly
2. Add lemon 🍋, onions 🧅, garlic 🧄, and olives 🫒. Cook until soft, about 15 min
3. Brown the merguez 🥓 in a skillet, reserve the rendered oil. Set aside
4. Stir flour 🌾 into the pot, add chicken stock 🍗 and simmer 5 min
5. Add merguez 🥓 with its oil, carrots 🥕, squash 🎃, zucchini 🥒, chickpeas 🫘, raisins and apricots 🍇. Cook 15 min until tender
6. Garnish with cilantro 🌿. Serve with couscous

Notes

Use a tagine if available, otherwise a dutch oven works great

Stir turmeric into the couscous before covering for a yellow hue

Pesto Beans

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🫒 8 tbsp olive oil
- 🌰 ¼ cup pine nuts or sliced almonds
- 🟡 ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 🧅 3 large shallots, thinly sliced
- 🧄 5 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 🫘 2 (400g) cans cannellini beans, drained
- 🍲 1 cup vegetable or chicken stock
- 🧀 1 cup finely grated Parmesan, plus more for serving
- 🌿 1½ cups tightly packed basil leaves
- 🍋 1 lemon, cut into wedges

Steps

1. Heat 6 tbsp olive oil 🫒 over medium-low. Add the pine nuts 🌰 and stir until golden, ~5 min. Stir in turmeric 🟡, season with salt & pepper, transfer nuts and oil to a bowl.
2. Heat remaining 2 tbsp olive oil 🫒 over medium-high. Add shallots 🧅 with a pinch of salt, cook ~3 min. Stir in garlic 🧄 for 1 min, then add beans 🫘 and stock 🍲. Bring to a simmer, reduce to low.
3. Sprinkle in Parmesan 🧀 in batches, stirring vigorously until creamy. Season with salt, turn off heat. Tear basil 🌿 and stir into the hot beans.
4. Serve drizzled with the sizzled nut oil, a squeeze of lemon 🍋, black pepper and extra Parmesan 🧀.

Tomates Farcies

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍅 4 large tomatoes (or 8 small)
- 🥩 500g sausage meat
- 🧅 3 onions, finely chopped
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌿 Fresh thyme + parsley
- 🧈 Butter (a knob per tomato)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 180°C
2. Mix half the onions 🧅 with sausage meat 🥩, garlic 🧄, parsley 🌿, salt and pepper 🧂
3. Cut tops off tomatoes 🍅, scoop out flesh. Season insides with salt and pepper 🧂. Fill with the meat stuffing 🥩, replace lids
4. Spread remaining onions 🧅 and tomato flesh in a baking dish. Place stuffed tomatoes 🍅 on top
5. Sprinkle with thyme 🌿, add a knob of butter 🧈 on each. Bake 1 hour

Notes

Serve with steamed rice

Dijon-Braised Brussels Sprouts

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥦 450g brussels sprouts, trimmed and halved
- 🧈 1 tbsp unsalted butter
- 🫗 1 tbsp olive oil
- 🧅 2–3 shallots, thinly sliced
- 🍷 1/2 cup dry white wine
- 🍗 1 cup chicken or vegetable broth
- 🥛 2 tbsp heavy cream
- 🟡 1 tbsp dijon mustard (or more to taste)
- 🌿 2 tbsp flat-leaf parsley, chopped (optional)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Heat butter 🧈 and oil 🫗 in a large skillet over medium heat
2. Place sprouts 🥦 cut-side down in one layer. Cook without turning until golden, about 5 min
3. Add shallots 🧅, wine 🍷, and broth 🍗. Bring to a simmer, cover, cook 15–20 min until tender
4. Remove sprouts 🥦. Add cream 🥛, simmer 2–3 min until thickened. Whisk in mustard 🟡
5. Season with salt and pepper 🧂. Pour sauce over sprouts 🥦, garnish with parsley 🌿

Notes

Brown sprouts in batches if they don't fit in one layer

Rice-Stuffed Tomatoes

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🍅 6 medium-large tomatoes
- 🍚 9 tbsp arborio rice
- 🧅 1/4 medium onion, finely chopped
- 🧄 1 garlic clove, minced
- 🌶️ Red pepper flakes to taste
- 🫗 2–3 tbsp olive oil
- 🌿 Few tbsp chopped parsley, oregano, or basil
- 📦 Handful of breadcrumbs (optional)
- 🧂 Salt to taste

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 175°C. Lightly oil a baking dish
2. Cut tops off tomatoes 🍅, scoop out flesh and juice into a bowl. Salt cavities, drain upside down
3. Pulse the scooped flesh into a coarse purée
4. Heat olive oil 🫗, sauté onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, and pepper flakes 🌶️ for 2 min. Add rice 🍚, toast 3 min
5. Add tomato purée, season with salt 🧂, cover and simmer 10–15 min until rice 🍚 is par-cooked. Stir in herbs 🌿
6. Fill tomatoes 🍅 to 7/8 full. Top with breadcrumbs 📦 or tomato lids. Bake uncovered 30 min

Notes

Leave room in the tomatoes for rice to finish expanding

Crêpes

Servings: 15

Ingredients

- 🌾 300g flour
- 🥚 3 eggs
- 🥛 75cl milk
- 🫗 3 tbsp oil

Steps

1. Mix flour 🌾, eggs 🥚, milk 🥛, and oil 🫗 until smooth
2. Cook one at a time in a non-stick crêpe pan over medium heat
3. Flip when edges lift and underside is golden, about 1 min per side

Notes

Rub pan with an oiled paper towel if not using non-stick

Fill with sugar & lemon, Nutella, or ham & cheese

Pancakes

Servings: 8-10 pancakes

Ingredients

- 🌾 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- 🥄 3 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 🍚 1 tbsp white sugar
- 🧂 1/4 tsp salt
- 🥛 1 1/4 cups milk
- 🧈 3 tbsp butter, melted
- 🥚 1 egg

Steps

1. Whisk together flour 🌾, baking powder 🥄, sugar 🍚, and salt 🧂
2. Add milk 🥛, melted butter 🧈, and egg 🥚. Whisk until smooth
3. Heat a lightly oiled pan over medium-high heat
4. Pour about 1/4 cup batter per pancake. Brown 2–3 min on each side. Serve hot

Notes

Add sliced fruit, vanilla extract, or cocoa powder to the batter for variations